

PRINTABLE FAMILY ESCAPE ROOM · AGES 8+

The North Pole

Escape Room

The sleigh won't launch! Crack 10 workshop puzzles and find the launch code before Christmas Eve.

10 puzzles | 60–90 minutes | 2–10 players | Host guide + answer key

Host guide

READ BEFORE YOU PLAY

The story

A snowstorm scrambled the memory of the sleigh's launch computer, and now the sleigh won't take off. Luckily, Juniper, the Chief Sleigh Engineer, hid a backup copy of the 10-letter launch code inside 10 puzzles around the workshop. Your players are the new elf crew. Each puzzle they solve gives them one letter of the code. When all 10 letters are on the Launch Panel, they say the code to you and the sleigh is ready to fly.

Who it's for

Families and groups, ages 8 and up. Kids 6–7 can play on a team with an older helper. Plan on 60–90 minutes. Play as one big team or race two teams (print one set per team).

What you need

- This file, printed (pages 4–19; one set per team)
- 12 envelopes (or folders) and tape
- Pencils; scissors for the host
- A small treat or a gift to "launch" at the end
- Optional: a timer, a small mirror (puzzle 10), and a box that closes as the "sleigh"

Printing

Print at "Actual size". Color is best (puzzles 6 and 7 use colors), but black and white also works.

Set-up (about 20 minutes).

1. Cut out the envelope labels (page 17) and stick one on each envelope.
2. Put each puzzle page (pages 6–15) in the envelope with its number. Put the Launch Panel (page 5) in the START envelope.
3. Hide envelopes 1–10 around the room or the house. Keep the START envelope and the story card (page 4) with you.
4. Cut out the hint cards (page 16) and keep them in your pocket.
5. Put the treat or gift in the "sleigh" with the FINALE half of the story card.
6. Optional: hang the door sign (page 19) and hand out the elf badges (page 18).

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Host guide

How to play

1. Gather the crew, hand out elf badges and read Juniper's message aloud (page 4, top half).
2. Hand over the START envelope and say "Go!" Start a 60-minute timer if you like.
3. Players find the envelopes and solve the puzzles in any order. Each puzzle tells them which letter of the code they found (letter 1, letter 2 and so on).
4. They write each letter in its box on the Launch Panel.
5. When all 10 boxes are full, they read the code to you. If it's right, they open the sleigh and you read the FINALE.

Teams

Racing two teams? Give each team its own printed set and hide the envelopes in two different rooms. First team to launch wins.

Hints

Every puzzle has a hint card. A good rule: a team can ask for a hint after 5 minutes on one puzzle, or trade a hint for a silly task (sing a line of a carol, do 10 reindeer jumps).

Making it easier

- Don't hide the envelopes; lay them out on the table.
- Tell younger players the code is a word for something cold that falls from the sky.
- Work through puzzles 2 and 5 together, out loud.

Making it harder

- Set a 45-minute timer.
- Hide envelopes inside each other: envelope 2 is only found after solving 1, and so on.
- No hint cards, or only three for the whole game.

Answers are on pages 20–21. Keep those pages (and the hint cards) away from the players. Each puzzle can also be checked on its own: its letter goes in the box at the bottom of the puzzle page.

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Story cards

HOST READS ALOUD · CUT IN HALF

READ FIRST

Attention, new elf crew!

This is Juniper, Chief Sleigh Engineer. Last night's snowstorm scrambled the sleigh's launch computer, and it has forgotten its 10-letter launch code. No code, no take-off, and Christmas Eve is coming fast!

I hid a backup of the code in 10 puzzles around the workshop. Each one gives you one letter. Solve them in any order, write each letter on the Launch Panel, and tell me the code. I'm counting on you.

Warm mittens and good luck,
Juniper

READ AT THE END

Launch code accepted: **SNOWFLAKES**! The lights are blinking, the bells are jingling, and the sleigh is ready to fly.

I picked that code for a reason. No two snowflakes are the same, and no two elves are either. Each of you solved something the others couldn't, and together you saved Christmas Eve. Please enjoy your reward from the sleigh.

With thanks from the whole workshop,
Juniper

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The Launch Panel

START HERE

The sleigh needs a 10-letter launch code. Find the 10 envelopes, solve each puzzle and write its letter in the matching box.

LETTER 1	LETTER 2	LETTER 3	LETTER 4	LETTER 5	LETTER 6	LETTER 7	LETTER 8	LETTER 9	LETTER 10

When every box is full, read the code out loud to your host.

Puzzle checklist

- [ ] 1 · Cookie Count
- [ ] 2 · Elf Radio
- [ ] 3 · The Snowy Forest
- [ ] 4 · Mixed-Up Workshop
- [ ] 5 · Who Opened the Gate?
- [ ] 6 · Spot the Difference
- [ ] 7 · Toy Shelf Grid
- [ ] 8 · What Comes Next?
- [ ] 9 · Workshop Word Search
- [ ] 10 · The Frosty Window



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1

PUZZLE 1 OF 10 · NUMBERS

Cookie Count

The baking elves label their cookie tins with pictures instead of numbers. Each picture stands for a number. Work out what each one is worth.





ELF NUMBER CODE

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
N	**O**	**P**	**Q**	**R**	**S**	**T**	**U**	**V**	**W**	**X**	**Y**	**Z**
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

Find your answer in the Elf number code. The letter above it is your letter.

Letter 1 of the launch code. Write it in box 1 on the Launch Panel.

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2

PUZZLE 2 OF 10 · CODES

Elf Radio

*A secret message crackled over the workshop radio. To keep it safe, the elves moved every letter **3 places forward** in the alphabet. Move each letter 3 places back to read it.*

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z

D → A H → E Q → N B → Y (go round the end)

O H W W H U W Z R L V Q

_____ _____ ____ __



☐ **Letter 2 of the launch code.** The message tells you which letter it is. Write it in box 2.

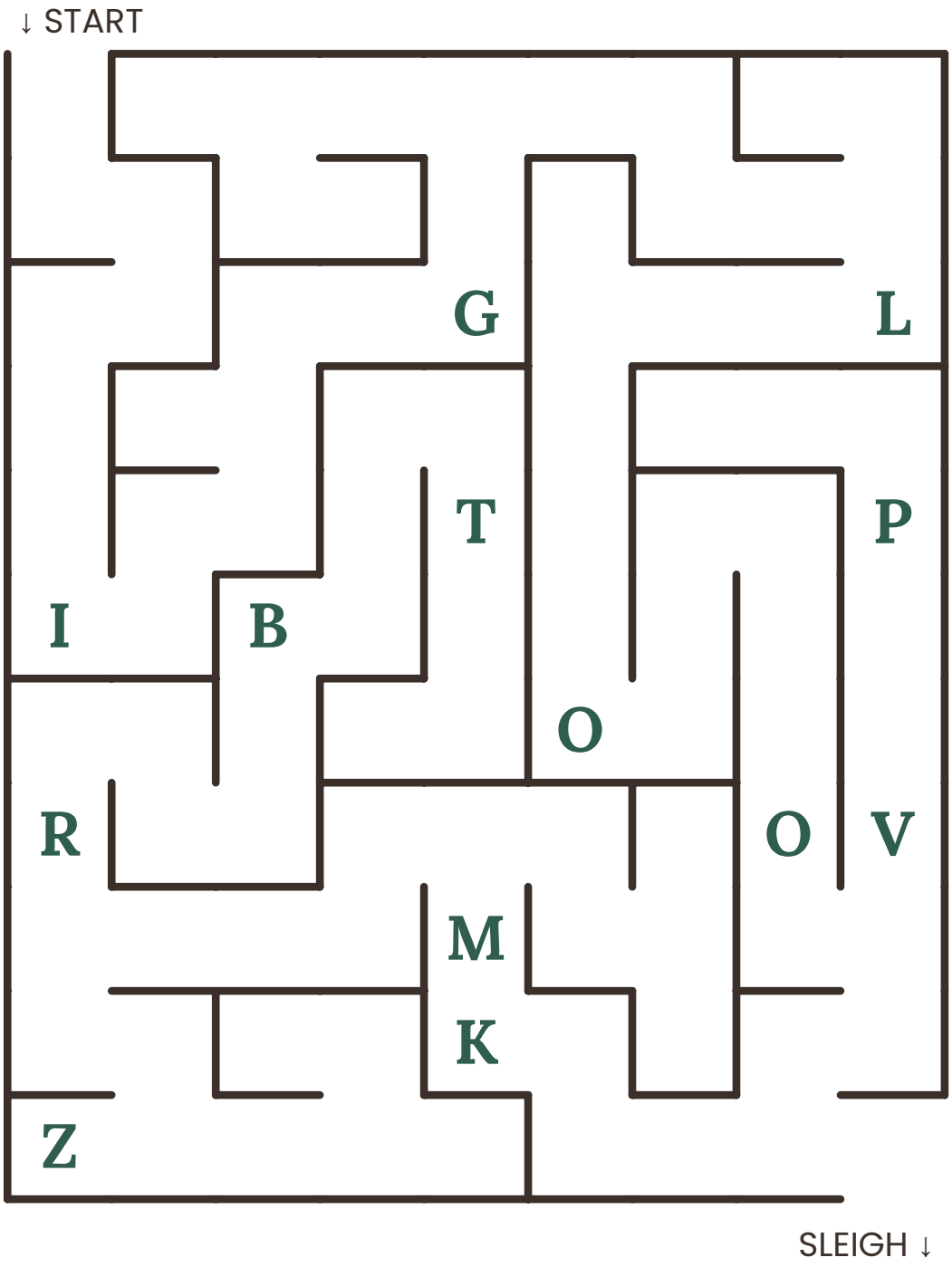
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3

PUZZLE 3 OF 10 · PATHS

The Snowy Forest

A reindeer took the only path through the snowy forest back to the sleigh. Follow it from START to SLEIGH and collect the letters you pass, in order. Letters off the path are snow-tricks!



Letters I collected: _____ (a snowy house!)

☐ **Letter 3 of the launch code.** It's the **last** letter of the word you collected. Write it in box 3.

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4

PUZZLE 4 OF 10 · WORDS

Mixed-Up Workshop

The storm blew the workshop labels around and mixed up their letters. Unscramble each word and write it in the boxes. The clues will help.

THWERA

A ring of greenery that hangs on the door

CLIECI

A frozen drip hanging from the roof

HNTRO

Which way to the Pole? Go …

NIART

A toy that goes choo-choo around the tree

VLESE

The busy helpers in the workshop

DREENIER

They pull the sleigh

Now read the **shaded** boxes from top to bottom. They spell a season: _____

Letter 4 of the launch code. It's the first letter of that season. Write it in box 4.

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5

PUZZLE 5 OF 10 · DETECTIVE

Who Opened the Gate?

Someone left the reindeer gate open, and the reindeer wandered off to play in the snow! It must have been the elf whose job is feeding the reindeer. Four elves each have one job. Who feeds the reindeer?


Fern


Milo


Pip


Ruby

1. The elf who wraps the presents has a name that starts with R.
2. Milo doesn't work with animals, and he never touches paint.
3. Pip sneezes around reindeer, so Pip never goes near the stable.

	Wrapping	Baking	Painting	Reindeer
Fern				
Milo				
Pip				
Ruby				

How to use the grid: put × for "no" and ✓ for "yes". Each elf has exactly one job, and each job belongs to exactly one elf. When a row or column has three ×, the last square must be ✓.

The reindeer feeder is: _____

☐ **Letter 5 of the launch code.** It's the first letter of that elf's name. Write it in box 5.

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PUZZLE 6 OF 10 · LOOKING

6 Spot the Difference

Juniper took two photos of the workshop yard, but the storm changed things in the second one! Circle every difference in the bottom picture.





Number of differences I found: _____ × 2 = _____

ELF NUMBER CODE

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
N	**O**	**P**	**Q**	**R**	**S**	**T**	**U**	**V**	**W**	**X**	**Y**	**Z**
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

☐ **Letter 6 of the launch code.** Double the number of differences, then find it in the Elf number code. That letter goes in box 6.

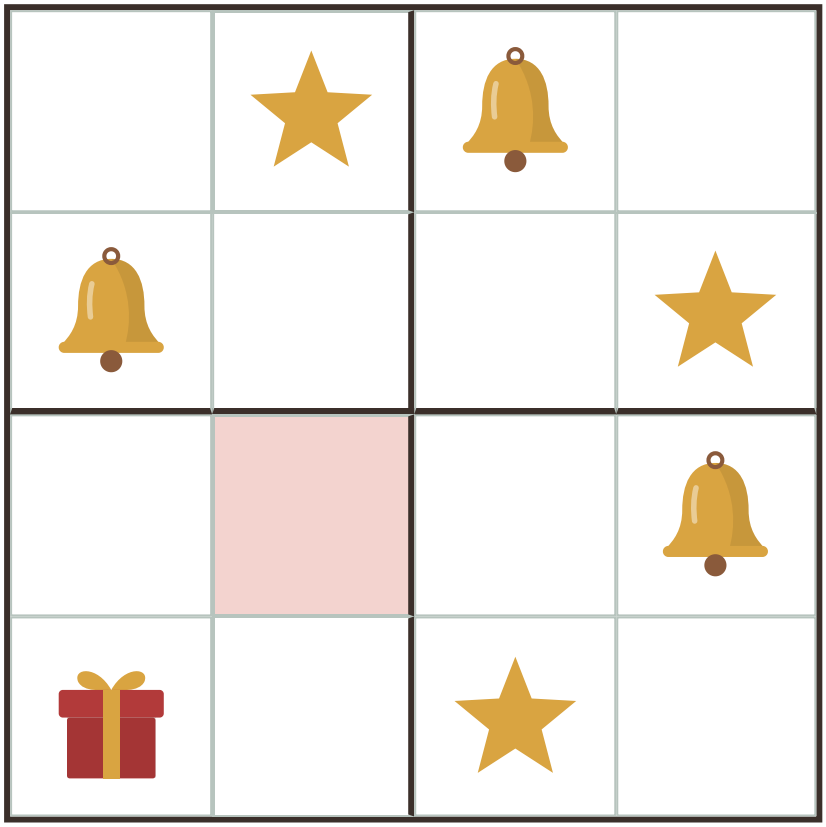
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PUZZLE 7 OF 10 · LOGIC

7 Toy Shelf Grid

The toy elves stock their shelves in a very exact way. Every row, every column and every 2×2 box must have one tree, one star, one bell and one gift.

Draw the missing pictures (a quick sketch is fine). Which picture goes in the **shaded** square?



Each picture is a letter:



Letter 7 of the launch code. The shaded square's letter goes in box 7.

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8

PUZZLE 8 OF 10 · PATTERNS

What Comes Next?

The sleigh's control lights blink in patterns. Find the missing number at the end of each row.

A 5 · 10 · 15 · ☐

B 2 · 4 · 8 · ☐

C 40 · 35 · 30 · ☐

Now work out the control sum: **A + B − C** = _____

ELF NUMBER CODE

A 1	**B** 2	**C** 3	**D** 4	**E** 5	**F** 6	**G** 7	**H** 8	**I** 9	**J** 10	**K** 11	**L** 12	**M** 13
N 14	**O** 15	**P** 16	**Q** 17	**R** 18	**S** 19	**T** 20	**U** 21	**V** 22	**W** 23	**X** 24	**Y** 25	**Z** 26

☐ **Letter 8 of the launch code.** Find your answer in the Elf number code. That letter goes in box 8.



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PUZZLE 9 OF 10 · WORDS

9 Workshop Word Search

Juniper hid a message in the workshop word search. Find and circle every word in the list. Words go across, down, or diagonally down to the right.

I	T	O	Y	S	N	O	W	L
C	W	I	N	T	E	R	E	T
I	A	W	W	R	E	A	T	H
C	T	R	H	E	B	E	L	L
L	R	A	O	O	S	T	A	R
E	N	P	I	L	L	L	N	E
C	O	O	K	I	E	L	E	I
T	I	N	S	E	L	S	Y	D
E	S	T	O	C	K	I	N	G

- ☐ BELL
- ☐ CAROL
- ☐ COOKIE
- ☐ HOLLY
- ☐ ICICLE
- ☐ SLED
- ☐ SNOW
- ☐ STAR
- ☐ STOCKING
- ☐ TINSEL
- ☐ TOYS
- ☐ WINTER
- ☐ WRAP
- ☐ WREATH

Now write the letters that are **not** in any word, in order: row by row, left to right, starting at the top.

_ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _

☐ **Letter 9 of the launch code.** The hidden message tells you the letter. Write it in box 9.

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10

PUZZLE 10 OF 10 · LOOKING

The Frosty Window

Juniper breathed on the workshop window and wrote the last clue in the frost, from the inside. From out here, it looks backwards! Read the message and copy it the right way round.



Tip: hold the page up to a mirror, or hold it up to a bright window and read it from the back.

_____

_____

☐ **Letter 10 of the launch code.** Write the letter in box 10. Then check the Launch Panel: is every box full?

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Hint cards

HOST KEEPS · CUT OUT

Hint 1: Cookie Count

Three gifts make 18, so one gift is 6. Use the gift to find the bell, then the bell to find the star.

Hint 2: Elf Radio

Count 3 letters back on the alphabet strip for each letter. O becomes L and H becomes E.

Hint 3: The Snowy Forest

Try the maze backwards: start at the SLEIGH and work toward START.

Hint 4: Mixed-Up Workshop

The first word hangs on the front door and starts with W.

Hint 5: Who Opened the Gate?

Clue 1 tells you Ruby wraps. Then Milo can only be baking. Who is left for painting?

Hint 6: Spot the Difference

Check the sky, the snowman's scarf, the colors of the gifts and the snow on the ground. There are 6.

Hint 7: Toy Shelf Grid

Look at the shaded square. Its row already has a bell, its column has a star, and its 2×2 box has a gift. What's left?

Hint 8: What Comes Next?

Row A counts up by 5. In row B each number doubles. Row C counts down by 5.

Hint 9: Workshop Word Search

Cross out each word's letters lightly. The leftover letters start with L-E-T-T-E-R.

Hint 10: The Frosty Window

The first word is THE. Read the letters from right to left if you have no mirror.

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Envelope labels

CUT OUT · TAPE ON ENVELOPES

★ **START**
Open first

1 **Cookie Count**
Puzzle 1 of 10

2 **Elf Radio**
Puzzle 2 of 10

3 **The Snowy Forest**
Puzzle 3 of 10

4 **Mixed-Up Workshop**
Puzzle 4 of 10

5 **Who Opened the Gate?**
Puzzle 5 of 10

6 **Spot the Difference**
Puzzle 6 of 10

7 **Toy Shelf Grid**
Puzzle 7 of 10

8 **What Comes Next?**
Puzzle 8 of 10

9 **Workshop Word Search**
Puzzle 9 of 10

10 **The Frosty Window**
Puzzle 10 of 10

♥ **FINALE**
Host only · goes in the sleigh

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Elf crew badges

CUT OUT · ONE PER PLAYER

NORTH POLE CREW



Sleigh Engineer

elf name

NORTH POLE CREW



Code Breaker

elf name

NORTH POLE CREW



Map Reader

elf name

NORTH POLE CREW



Cookie Inspector

elf name

NORTH POLE CREW



Light Checker

elf name

NORTH POLE CREW



Snow Scout

elf name

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NORTH POLE WORKSHOP

Sleigh Launch *Control Room*

Authorized elves only. Puzzle solvers welcome.

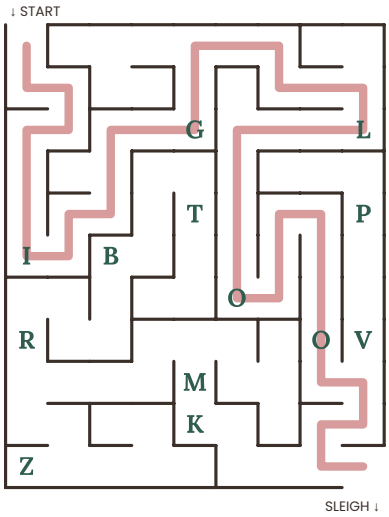


Answer key

1 = S Gift = 6 (18 ÷ 3), bell = 4 (10 - 6), star = 5 (9 - 4). Gift × bell - star = 24 - 5 = 19, and 19 = S.

2 = N OHWWHU WZR LV Q moved 3 letters back reads LETTER TWO IS N.

3 = O The path collects I-G-L-O-O (IGLOO). The last letter is O.



4 = W WREATH, ICICLE, NORTH, TRAIN, ELVES, REINDEER. The shaded letters spell WINTER. First letter: W.

5 = F Clue 1: Ruby wraps. Clue 2: Milo isn't on reindeer or painting, so Milo bakes. Clue 3: Pip isn't on reindeer, so Pip paints. Fern feeds the reindeer: F.

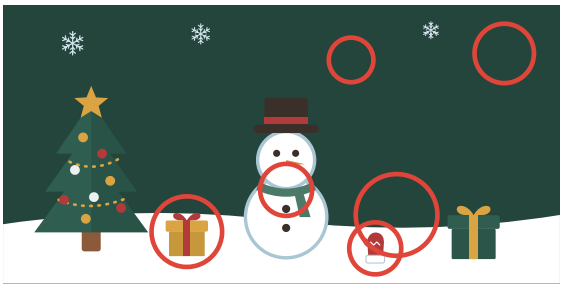
Fern	Reindeer
Milo	Baking
Pip	Painting
Ruby	Wrapping

The launch code: S N O W F L A K E S

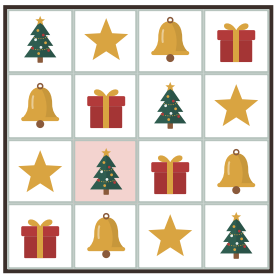
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Answer key

6 = L 6 differences: the moon, one snowflake and the candy cane are missing; the snowman's scarf is green; the left gift is gold; a mitten is lying in the snow. 6 × 2 = 12, and 12 = L.



7 = A The shaded square (row 3, column 2) is the tree, and tree = A.



8 = K A = 20, B = 16, C = 25. 20 + 16 − 25 = 11, and 11 = K.

9 = E The leftover (pink) letters read LETTER NINE IS E.

I	T	O	Y	S	N	O	W	L
C	W	I	N	T	E	R	E	T
I	A	W	W	R	E	A	T	H
C	T	R	H	E	B	E	L	L
L	R	A	O	O	S	T	A	R
E	N	P	I	L	L	L	N	E
C	O	O	K	I	E	L	E	I
T	I	N	S	E	L	S	Y	D
E	S	T	O	C	K	I	N	G

10 = S The window says THE TENTH AND LAST LETTER OF THE CODE IS S.

The launch code: S N O W F L A K E S

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OFFICIAL NORTH POLE CERTIFICATE

Sleigh Launched!

This certifies that

_____

name(s)

cracked all 10 workshop puzzles and found the launch code just in time for Christmas Eve.

Time: _____ Date: _____



Signed, Juniper, Chief Sleigh Engineer